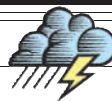


The Washington Post

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Democracy Dies in Darkness

SUNDAY, JULY 13, 2025 • \$6

Plans form to expel migrants to 3rd nations

Thousands could be sent to where they lack family ties or common language

BY MARIA SACCHETTI,
CAROL D. LEONNIG
AND MARIANNE LEVINE

Federal immigration officers may deport immigrants with as little as six hours' notice to countries other than their own even if officials have not provided any assurances that the new arrivals will be safe from persecution or torture, a top official said in a memo last week.

Todd M. Lyons, the acting director of U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement, wrote in a memo to the ICE workforce Wednesday that a Supreme Court ruling last month had cleared the way for officers to "immediately" start sending immigrants to "alternative" countries.

People being sent to countries where officials have not provided any "diplomatic assurances" that immigrants will be safe will be informed 24 hours in advance — and in "exigent" circumstances, just six. Those being flown to places that have offered those assurances could be deported with no advance notice.

If the State Department "believes those assurances to be credible," he wrote, then ICE may deport someone to that country "without the need for further procedures."

The United States has rarely deported people to countries where they are not citizens, and lawyers warned that thousands of longtime immigrants with work permits and families in the U.S. could now be uprooted and

SEE **DEPORTATIONS** ON **A9**

When AI bots cross the line, who takes responsibility?

BY DREW HARWELL
AND NITASHA TIKU

A tech company employee who went on an antisemitic tirade like X's Grok chatbot did last week would soon be out of a job. Spewing hate speech to millions of people and invoking Adolf Hitler is not something a CEO can brush aside as a worker's bad day at the office.

But after the chatbot developed by Elon Musk's start-up xAI ranted for hours about a second Holocaust and spread conspiracy theories about Jewish people, the company responded by deleting some of the troubling posts and sharing a statement suggesting the chatbot just needed some algorithmic tweaks.

Grok officials in a statement Saturday apologized and blamed the episode on a code update that unexpectedly made the AI more susceptible to echoing X posts with "extremist views."

The incident, which was horrifying even by the standards of a platform that has become a haven for extreme speech, has raised uncomfortable questions about accountability when AI chatbots go rogue. When an automated system breaks the rules, who bears the blame, and what should the consequences be?

But it also demonstrated the

SEE **AI** ON **A5**



SALWAN GEORGES/THE WASHINGTON POST

One year later. Multiple lives altered.

Survivors of the Butler rally shooting are still untangling how a sizzling July day warped their worlds

BY DANIELLE PAQUETTE

BUTLER, PA. — One year ago, eight bullets fired in under six seconds scarred the American psyche.

Millions watched live as Donald Trump abruptly stopped speaking, clutched his ear and then dropped to the ground below a human shield of Secret Service agents. The gunman barely missed: A quarter-inch stood between the now-president of the United States and history-altering calamity.

The attempted assassination jolted a fractured nation and transformed the 2024 campaign, boosting Trump in the polls after inspiring a minutes-later endorsement from the world's rich-



JABIN BOTSFORD/THE WASHINGTON POST

Veteran Carl Curtis and his granddaughter Ava wait for Donald Trump to speak at a rally last year in Butler, Pennsylvania, where a shooting would soon unfold. Curtis has done his best to help Ava process the tragedy.

In hunt for gunman's motive, FBI finds a loner and a mystery

BY CAROL D. LEONNIG

On the morning of Sunday, July 14, 2024, just 16 hours after a gunman tried to kill Donald Trump, top officials gathered in the White House Situation Room to brief President Joe Biden on what the FBI knew about the would-be assassin.

Could Iran be behind this plot to murder the former president, Biden asked?

Attorney General Merrick

Garland and FBI Director Christopher A. Wray told Biden they were indeed concerned Iran might have recruited the man who fired at Trump during his rally in Butler, Pennsylvania, according to three people with knowledge of the briefing. Hours earlier, in fact, FBI agents had rushed to Texas in the middle of the night to interview an alleged Iranian operative the bureau had arrested Friday on

SEE **MOTIVE** ON **A14**

Many in MAGA see God's hand, buoying belief in divine mandate

BY ISAAC ARNSDORF

CONNOQUENESSING, PA. — On the road from Pittsburgh to Butler, past the cornfields and farm stands, before the fairgrounds where a shooter nearly killed Donald Trump a year ago Sunday, billboards quote 1 Corinthians and Psalm 27. Another sign advertises a local church with a photo of an American flag twisted into the shape of a Y.

The reference is unmistakable for most anyone who attended that fateful rally on July 13, 2024. A few hours before Trump spoke, the 30-by-60-foot flag suspended over the stage got wrapped up in the wind.

"Some people thought it looked like an angel," said Keith Karns, the pastor of the Church of God at Connoquenessing.

The image of the twisted flag quickly joined the constellation

SEE **RELIGION** ON **A11**



MARCO BELLO/REUTERS

Personal belongings at the Texas camp after the flooding in which scores were killed or went missing.

In the flooded dark, a prayer: A tale of persistence at Mystic

A counselor recounts how she, 2 colleagues and a cabin's 16 'littles' responded to deadly deluge

BY JOHN WOODROW COX

The first drops of rain had yet to fall when Ainslie Bashara, a counselor at Camp Mystic, noticed that one of the younger girls had begun to tear up. They were walking back to their cabin, Gigggle Box, as another storm swelled over the Texas Hill Country. The girl feared what was coming, so Ainslie wrapped an arm around her.

"It's just heat lightning," Ainslie, 19, recalled assuring her that evening. "There's nothing to it."

It was just past 9 p.m. on July 3,

the start of Ainslie's night off from tending to Gigggle Box's 16 "littles." She popped inside to grab her backpack just as the girls, all between 8 and 10, began to brush their teeth and slip on their pajamas. Ainslie said goodbye and headed out for a break with friends. By the time she came back, shortly after midnight, she had to sprint. The storm had begun to pound the 99-year-old Christian camp situated along the Guadalupe River. The cabin was no more than 600 feet from the bank.

SEE **CAMP MYSTIC** ON **A6**

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